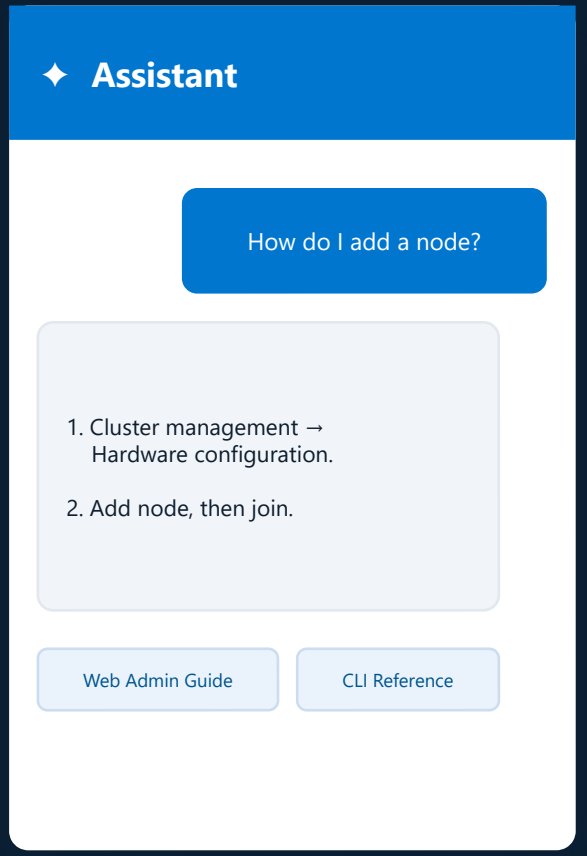
CONCEPT PROPOSAL · DELL POWERSCALE

PowerScale Assistant

An expert OneFS administrator, embedded in the console.



Runs 100% local · grounded in official OneFS 9.12 documentation · nothing leaves the cluster

THE PROBLEM

OneFS is powerful — but expert-gated

The knowledge to run it exists. It just isn't where the admin is working — so routine questions become tab-switches and support cases.



Deep, dense product

11 official manuals, thousands of pages. Answers exist — buried.



Out of the workflow

Help means leaving the console for a PDF, a KB portal, or a ticket.



Expert-gated

Junior admins stall on senior knowledge; mistakes drive support load.

WHY TODAY'S HELP FAILS

Today's “help” is a PDF and a support case — neither is in the workflow

1

Admin hits a question

mid-task, in the WebUI

→

2

Leaves the console

PDF · KB portal · ticket

→

3

Context is lost

version drift, guesswork

→

4

Slow resolution

or a Dell support case

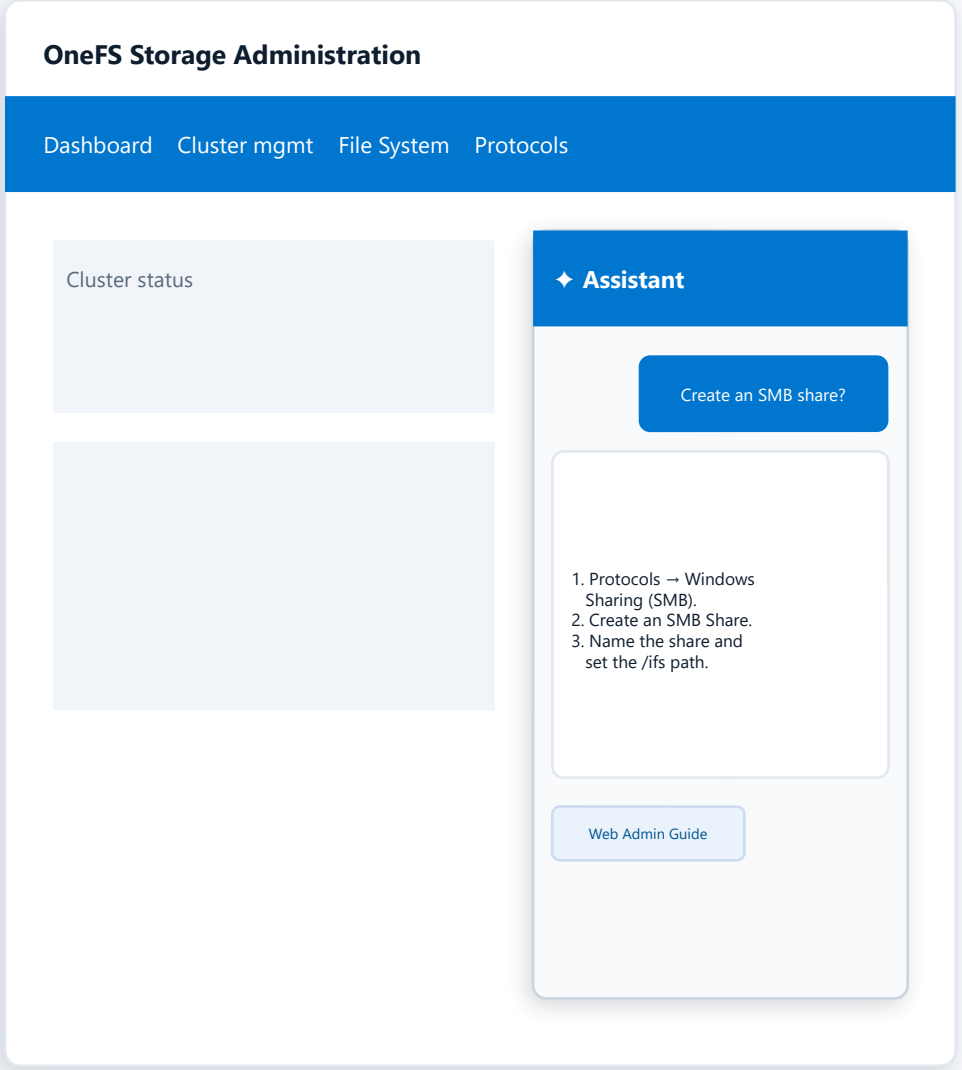
Every detour is time the admin doesn't have — and a chance to misconfigure the cluster.

THE CONCEPT

We embedded the docs as a cited expert, right inside the WebUI

Ask in plain English without leaving the console.
Answers come only from official OneFS docs, with source citations — and if the docs don't cover it, it says so instead of guessing.

- ✓ Grounded in official documentation
- ✓ Cites its sources on every answer
- ✓ Says “I don't know” — no hallucination



PROOF — IT ALREADY WORKS

It already works — fully local, nothing leaves the cluster

WebUI
embedded panel

→

RAG engine
retrieve + ground

→

Local knowledge
ChromaDB · OneFS docs

→

Local LLM
Ollama · llama3.1:8b

No internet. No cloud. No data egress — the property that makes it adoptable in air-gapped clusters.

11
official manuals indexed

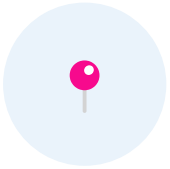
5,205
passages searchable

0.73–0.79
retrieval relevance

0
answers that leave the box

NOT A CHATBOT IN A TAB

It's woven into the console, and its answers are actionable



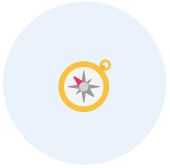
Context-aware

Knows which page you're on; tailors answers and suggestions to it.



Explain this event

Click an alert; get a plain-English cause and fix, cited from the docs.



Click-to-navigate

Answers link to the right WebUI screen and take you there.



Copyable CLI

Commands render as ready-to-run, one-click-copy code blocks.

HOW IT INTEGRATES — HONESTLY

Run it as a sidecar, not on the storage nodes — the air-gap stays intact

On-cluster

Low–Med

Inside OneFS with the WebUI. Smallest footprint, but LLM inference competes with storage I/O on FreeBSD nodes with no GPU.

Sidecar appliance

High · recommended

A small Linux VM/container beside the cluster. Keeps inference off storage nodes, stays on-prem and air-gap-friendly.

CloudIQ / APEX AIOps

High (connected)

Dell-hosted SaaS. Best model quality and central updates — for customers who allow the connectivity Dell already ships.

PHASED ROADMAP

Read-only first, actions later — trust gates the roadmap, not capability

0

NOW

Doc Q&A

Embedded, cited answers. (Today's prototype.)

1

Live read-only

Grounds in this cluster's real state via the Platform API.

2

Guided actions

Write actions behind RBAC, confirmation, and audit.

3

Cross-product

Fleet-wide via CloudIQ / APEX AIOps.

4

Proactive

Detects, recommends, and predicts.

BEYOND POWERSCALE

One engine, the whole Dell portfolio — with CloudIQ as the hub

Same pattern everywhere: docs + an embeddable panel + a read-only API connector. Build the engine once; add a corpus and a connector per product.

PowerStore · PowerMax · Unity

Storage REST APIs

PowerEdge · iDRAC

Redfish standard — one connector, many

PowerProtect · Data Domain

Backup admin, simplified

VxRail

Embed in VxRail Manager



THE BET

Fewer tickets. Faster admins. A stickier platform.

Deflect support cases

Admins self-serve from the docs instead of opening Dell cases.

Lower the expertise barrier

Junior admins get senior-level guidance — expanding who can run OneFS.

A product feedback flywheel

Anonymized questions reveal doc gaps and unmet needs Dell can't see today.

The ask: green-light a Phase 0–1 pilot on a sidecar with two design-partner clusters.